

Word family: **mixture / mixtures / mix / mixed / mixing**

Base word: mixture

Related base verb: mix

Related forms: mixed, mixing

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / related verb and adjective forms (相關動詞及形容詞)

Your sentence:

> “I feel a **mixture** of admiration and calm when I think about that animal.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **mixture** means a **combination of two or more different feelings experienced at the same time**.

繁體中文：兩種或以上不同感受同時存在、混合在一起的狀態；混合感受

中文翻譯：

> “I feel a **mixture** of admiration and calm...”

「每當我想起那隻動物時，我都會感到一種由佩服和寧靜交織而成的**複合感受 / 混合感覺**。」

Here:

a mixture of admiration and calm = 佩服和寧靜兩種感受同時存在

1. **mixture = combination of different substances/things (混合物) — 混合物；混合體**

This is the central literal meaning.

Meaning: A substance or thing made by combining two or more different substances or elements.

Practice 1

> “The bowl contained a **mixture** of flour, sugar, and butter.”

「碗裡是一種由麵粉、糖和牛油組成的**混合物**。」

Practice 2

> “The drink is a **mixture** of fruit juice and sparkling water.”

「這杯飲品是果汁和有汽水的****混合物****。」

****mixture = 由兩種或以上不同物質或成分混合而成的整體****

Common:

- * chemical mixture
- * mixture of ingredients
- * mixture of liquids
- * mixture of colours

2. ****mixture = combination of different qualities/elements (特質 / 元素) — 混合 ; 結合****

****Mixture**** can refer to a combination of non-physical qualities, styles, features, or influences.

Practice 3

> “The city is a ****mixture**** of old and new.”

「這座城市是古老與現代的****融合 / 混合體****。」

Practice 4

> “Her style is a ****mixture**** of elegance and simplicity.”

「她的風格是優雅與簡約的****結合****。」

****mixture = 不同特質、風格、元素或影響同時存在並結合在一起****

This is a major abstract extension of Meaning 1.

3. ****mixture = combination of feelings (情緒) — 複雜 / 混合感受****

This is the meaning used in your passage.

****Meaning:**** Two or more feelings experienced together at the same time.

Practice 5 — Original

> “I feel a ****mixture**** of admiration and calm.”

「我感到一種佩服和寧靜交織的**混合感受**。」

Practice 6

> “She felt a **mixture** of excitement and nervousness.”

「她同時感到興奮和緊張，一種很複雜的**混合感受**。」

Practice 7

> “His expression showed a **mixture** of relief and sadness.”

「他的表情流露出如釋重負和傷感交織的**複雜情緒**。」

****mixture of feelings = 多種不同情緒同時存在，形成複合感受****

For strict counting, I would merge this with Meaning 2 under the broad concept:

> ****combination of different non-physical elements****

but it is common enough to display explicitly.

4. ****mixture = group containing different kinds of people/things (多樣組合) — 混合組合；各種不同事物的集合****

****Mixture**** can refer to a collection made up of different kinds.

Practice 8

> “The audience was a **mixture** of students and professionals.”

「觀眾由學生和專業人士**混合組成**。」

Practice 9

> “The shop sells a **mixture** of modern and traditional products.”

「這間店售賣現代和傳統產品的**混合組合**。」

****mixture = 由不同種類的人、物或類別共同組成的整體****

This is still the broad combination sense and does not need a new core category.

5. **mixture = prepared medicinal substance (藥劑 , 較舊 / 英式) — 合劑 ; 藥水**

In older or more formal British medical usage, **mixture** can mean a liquid medicine made from several ingredients.

Practice 10

> “The doctor prescribed a cough **mixture**.”

「醫生開了一種止咳**藥水 / 合劑**。」

Practice 11

> “Take one spoonful of the **mixture** twice a day.”

「每天服用兩次，每次一匙這種**藥水**。」

mixture = 由多種成分配製而成的液體藥劑

This is established but lower-priority in modern general English.

Related form: **mix**

Mix is the core verb.

**mix = combine things together (混合) **

Practice 12

> “Mix the flour and water together.”

「把麵粉和水**混合**在一起。」

Practice 13

> “The colours **mixed** naturally.”

「那些顏色自然地**混在一起**。」

mix = 把兩種或以上不同事物結合，使它們形成一個整體

Related form: ****mixed****

****Mixed**** has several useful branches.

****mixed = containing different kinds (混合的)****

Practice 14

> “We ordered a ****mixed**** salad.”

「我們點了一份****雜錦 / 混合****沙律。」

****mixed feelings = 複雜感受****

Practice 15

> “I have ****mixed feelings**** about the decision.”

「我對這個決定有****複雜 / 矛盾的感受****。」

****mixed feelings = 同時存在不同甚至相反的情緒****

This is particularly relevant to ****mixture of admiration and calm****.

Related form: ****mixing****

Practice 16

> “Careful ****mixing**** is important.”

「仔細****混合****很重要。」

****mixing = 把不同成分混合在一起的過程****

Important distinction: ****mixture vs mix****

****mixture****

usually refers to the ****result or combined whole****.

****mix****

can be:

- * the verb meaning combine
- * an informal noun meaning a combination

- > a mixture of emotions
- > mix the ingredients

So **mixture** is generally the more formal noun.

Important distinction: **mixture vs combination**

combination

is very broad and simply means things brought together.

mixture

more strongly suggests the components are blended, intermingled, or coexist together.

- > a combination of skills

very natural.

- > a mixture of feelings

very natural.

There is substantial overlap, but **mixture** often feels more integrated/intermingled.

Important distinction: **mixture vs blend**

blend

often suggests the components combine smoothly and harmoniously.

mixture

is neutral and does not imply harmony.

- > a blend of flavours

suggests smooth combination.

> a mixture of emotions

can include conflicting feelings.

Important distinction: **mixture vs compound**

In chemistry:

mixture

= substances are physically combined but retain their own identities.

compound

= elements are chemically bonded into a new substance.

So:

mixture ≠ chemical compound

This is an important academic distinction.

Important distinction: **mixture vs mixed feelings**

Your passage says:

> **a mixture of admiration and calm**

This means:

> both feelings are present together.

mixed feelings, however, often suggests more strongly that the feelings are **different or conflicting**, such as:

> happy + sad

> excited + worried

So they overlap, but **mixed feelings** often has a stronger emotional-conflict nuance.

Countability note

****Mixture**** is usually countable when referring to one combined whole:

- > a mixture
- > several mixtures

But in some technical contexts it can function more generally:

- > “Mixture occurs during the process.”

For general learner use, treating it as countable is safest.

Family-extension note

The practical modern family includes:

- * ****mixture****
- * ****mixtures****
- * ****mix****
- * ****mixed****
- * ****mixing****

Useful constructions include:

- * mixture of ingredients
- * mixture of styles
- * mixture of feelings
- * mixed feelings
- * cough mixture

The Golden Manual says closely related literal and figurative combinations should be grouped when one broad semantic idea — here, ****different things combined together**** — explains them naturally.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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mixture — physical combination	由兩種或以上不同物質或成分混合而成的整體 / 混合物
mixture — abstract combination	不同特質、風格、元素、感受等同時存在並結合在一起

	mixture of feelings	多種不同情緒同時存在形成的複合感受
	mixture — diverse group	由不同類別的人或物共同組成的整體；屬於 combination 義
	mixture — medicine	由多種成分配製而成的液體藥劑；較舊 / 較英式
	mix	把不同事物混合、結合
	mixed	由不同種類組成的；mixed feelings 則指複雜 / 矛盾感受

For your original sentence

> “I feel a ****mixture**** of admiration and calm when I think about that animal.”

The exact meaning is:

****mixture = 兩種不同感受同時存在並交織在一起****

So:

> ****a mixture of admiration and calm****

= ****佩服與寧靜交織而成的一種複合感受****

For your database, I would count ****2 genuinely useful core meanings**** for ****mixture****:

1. ****a physical combination of different substances/components****
2. ****an abstract combination of different qualities, styles, people, or feelings****

I would keep ****mixture of emotions**** under #2, treat medicinal ****mixture**** as a lower-priority domain extension, and keep ****mix / mixed / mixing**** as family forms rather than inflate the base-word count.